

# The Game Changers INDIVIDUALS

AGK MENON 68 FOUNDER, School of Architecture and Planning, Delhi

## MADE IN INDIA

Searching for a means to make architecture more 'context-specific', AGK Menon along with fellow architects A.B. Lall, Ashish Ganju and K.L. Nadir, a social scientist, founded the TVB School of Habitat Studies, now the School of Architecture and Planning (SAP), in 1990. "Our education system dumbs down the learning curve by trying to make it student-centric," says Menon, convener, INTACH (Delhi Chapter) and coordina-

tor, SAP, Indraprastha University. Inculcating the three-part mission of culture, modernity and the consciousness of poverty into the curriculum, Menon says, research has become central to imparting education in architecture at SAP. He also developed the Indian Charter for Conservation for INTACH, to provide an alternative to the dominant European Charters of Conservation, which are being followed till date.

by Purvi Malhotra



**Education** B.Arch from IIT, Kharagpur, M.Sc in Architecture from Illinois Institute of Technology, Chicago, and M.Sc in Urban Planning from Columbia University.

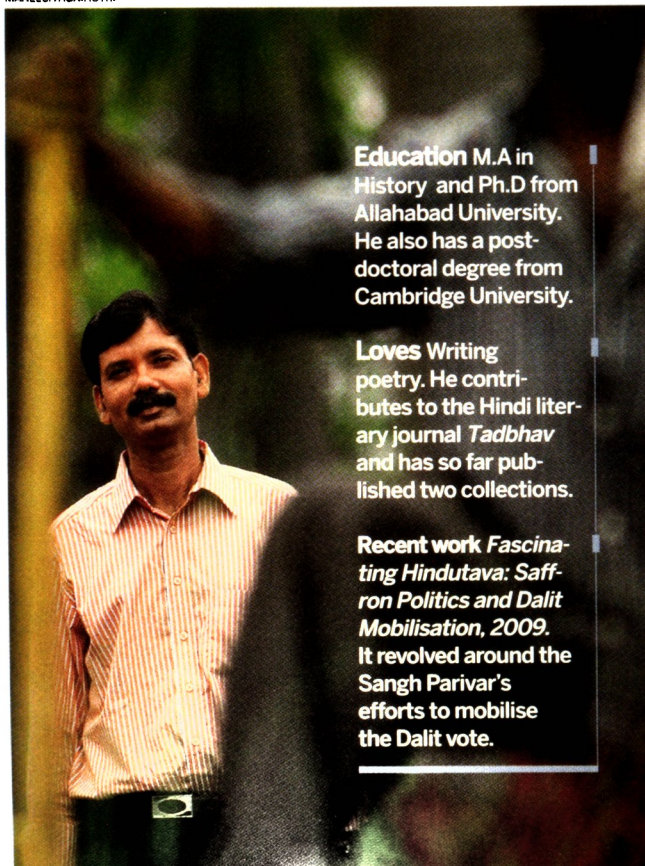
**Usually to be found** "Because I wear too many hats, that of convener of INTACH (Delhi Chapter), coordinator of SAP, writing for journals and books, and of course, pursuing my consultancy, I'm constantly chasing my own tail," he says.

**Mantra for change** Let's know ourselves first and then look for solutions to our many problems.

**"He has the critical ability to combine professional skills with a vision in the academic arena."** Raj Rewal, Architect and Urban Design Consultant

BADRI NARAYAN 44 HEAD, Dalit Resource Centre, G.B. Pant Social Sciences Institute, Allahabad

MANEESH AGNIHOTRI



**Education** M.A in History and Ph.D from Allahabad University. He also has a post-doctoral degree from Cambridge University.

**Loves Writing** poetry. He contributes to the Hindi literary journal *Tadbhav* and has so far published two collections.

**Recent work** *Fascinating Hindutava: Saffron Politics and Dalit Mobilisation*, 2009. It revolved around the Sangh Parivar's efforts to mobilise the Dalit vote.

## EMBEDDED SCHOLAR

It's not an accident that nine of the 12 papers at a seminar in Canberra last June on the politics of marginalisation were devoted to cultural anthropologist Badri Narayan's findings. For the Fulbright scholar and Smuts Fellow at Cambridge is one of the few academics involved in actively documenting and analysing history as it happens. Using unexplored sources like folklore, collective memory

and oral history, he has created a fascinating study of Dalit politics, be it unearthing facets of the Mayawati phenomenon or understanding how the Sangh Parivar is trying to saffronise Dalit heroes. Whether it be a text he has written that has become part of the syllabus at Oberlin College, USA, or his arguments against the bipartisan politicisation of Dalits, he is never too far from the headlines. by Farzand Ahmed

**"His approach to the subject brings a fresh perspective to the study of Dalit issues."**

Rajen Harshe, Vice-Chancellor, Allahabad University